Revision:
06/01/2022

Background:
To apply for CalFresh benefits an application must be submitted. CalFresh applicants must then complete an interview and provide verification of certain information.

Purpose:
This section provides guidance on acceptable application forms, determining the beginning date of aid, and the processing of combo applications. This section is being revised after sunset review, there are no changes due to state legislation.

Policy:
Any of the following forms may be used to apply for CalFresh:

- Application for CalFresh Benefits (CF 285)
- Initial Application for CalFresh, Cash-Aid, and/or Medi-Cal/Healthcare Programs (SAWS 1)
- Application for CalFresh, Cash-Aid, and/or Medi-Cal/Healthcare Programs (SAWS 2 Plus)

Application forms must be available to customers at each Family Resource Center (FRC) lobby. An application must be accepted as long as it contains the following minimum requirements: applicant's name, address, and signature of a responsible household (HH) member or Authorized Representative (AR). Applications may be submitted in person, by mail, online, faxed, or by phone. Applications submitted with electronic or telephonic signatures are acceptable. Customers applying for multiple programs will only have to complete one application and one interview.

1. Public Assistance (PA) and CalFresh Application:
An application submitted for PA shall be considered a request for both PA and CalFresh, unless it is determined otherwise during the interview. When processing a PA and CalFresh application, eligibility for CalFresh benefits will be based on CalFresh regulations, including Expedited Services (ES). If PA is denied, CalFresh must continue to be evaluated.

2. Establishing the Beginning Date of Aid (BDA):
The date the application is received by the county establishes the BDA. The date the application is received must be recorded on the application. If an application is received outside of normal business hours, the beginning date of aid will be the next business day.

If the application is submitted …	**then the date of application will be …**
within regular business hours,	the date that the application is received by the county.
after regular business hours,	the next business day from the date that the application was received by the county. *Example:* Application was received on Monday at 5:30 PM. Date of application will be Tuesday.
on a non-business day,	the next business day from the date that the application was received by the county. *Example:* Application was submitted on Saturday at 9:30 AM. Date of application will be Monday. If Monday is a holiday and the office is closed, the date of application will be Tuesday.

Note: Regular business hours are 7AM – 5PM Monday through Friday.

3. Establishing the Semi-Annual Report (SAR) Payment Period:

The BDA establishes the SAR payment period. The SAR payment period begins the first month the customer is eligible to receive benefits. If the customer is not eligible to receive benefits in the month of application, the SAR payment period will begin in the second month.

Example: Establishing BDA and SAR Cycle	
Scenario	Customer applies in January, is not eligible for benefits in January, but is approved for benefits in February and ongoing.
Outcome	February 1st is the BDA and the SAR cycle begins in February.

4. Month of Application**:**

Eligibility in the month of application is determined by the HH circumstances as of the date of the interview. Exceptions to this include HH that consist of the following individuals:

HH Types	Refer to
Strikers	63-101 Household Concept for guidance on determining eligibility for strikers
Voluntary Quit	63-159 Voluntary Quit and the Reduction of Work Effort for guidance on determining eligibility for customers who have voluntary quit a job
Resource Transfers	63-201 Resource Eligibility Determination for guidance on determining eligibility when there has been a transfer of resources
Migrant and seasonal farmworkers that meet the destitute criteria	63-252 Household's with Migrant or Seasonal Farmworkers for guidance on determining eligibility for Migrant or seasonal farmworkers that meet the destitute criteria in the month of application
Categorically Eligible (CE)	63-120 Categorical Eligibility (CE) for guidance on determining CalFresh eligibility for CE HH

5. Proration of Benefits:

Most of the time, a HH will not get a full month's benefits in the month of application, this is also referred to as proration. CalFresh benefits are prorated from the date the application was received and customers will be issued benefits for the days remaining in the month. Refer to section 63-109 Time Limits and Delays for further guidance on timely processing. The table below describes proration of benefits in the month of application:

If …	Then …
all required verifications are received timely,	benefits will be prorated from the date the application is received.
processing the application is delayed beyond 30 days due to the fault of the HH but is found eligible during the second 30-day period,	benefits will be prorated from the date the customer submits all required verifications.

processing the application is delayed beyond 30 days due to the fault of the county,	benefits will be prorated retroactive to the date of the application.

Note: Migrant or seasonal farmworker HH's that have a break in aid of 30 days or less will not have their benefits prorated, they will receive the full month's benefit.

6. CalFresh Application Used to Apply for Medi-Cal:
Upon the return of a CalFresh application, if the customer indicates interest in applying for Medi-Cal, the information captured on the CalFresh application will be used to complete an eligibility determination for Medi-Cal. If there is no active or pending Medi-Cal, collect the Request for Tax Household Information (RFTHI) from the customer. The Medi-Cal BDA will be established upon receipt of the RFTHI. Refer to MPG 04.02.13A for further guidance when processing a Medi-Cal eligibility determination using a CalFresh application.

7. Verification Procedure for Combo Applications:
Verifications received for other programs can be used to help determine eligibility for CalFresh. Do not delay processing the CalFresh application while waiting for verifications for other programs. Approve CalFresh as soon as all verifications have been received, even if there are pending verifications for other programs. If other programs are denied, continue to evaluate CalFresh eligibility based on the original application. CalFresh cannot be denied for failure to provide before the 30th day even if the PA application is denied sooner. Refer to 63-117 Verification and Documentation for guidance on mandatory CalFresh verifications.

Other Program Impacts:
CalWORKs, CAPI, GR, MC

References:
MPP 63-300.2; MPP 63-301.6; MPP 63-503; MPG 04.02.13A; ACWDL 01-10; ACL 15-84; AB 59; SB 493

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 06/30/2025.

Approval for Release:

6-6-22

RICK WANNE, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services